

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 3
♥ A J T 6
♦ Q 8 3 2
♣ K J 3

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4



♠ T 5
♥ K Q 4 3
♦ J T 5 4
♣ A T 7

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 9 5 2

♦ K 9

♣ 9 8 6 2

NORTH has an opening hand, 15 points, and a 5-card ♠ suit. Unfortunately WEST beat her to the punch by opening 1♥.

But NORTH should get into the bidding anyway, by Overcalling 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

SOUTH has 6 points. If NORTH had actually OPENED 1♠, SOUTH would be obligated to bid. But knowing that the Overcall will not be made with more than 16 points, SOUTH just passes.

West

1♥

All Pass

1♠ by North

North

1♠

East

South

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ T 3
 ♥ A Q J 6
 ♦ T 8 5
 ♣ T 8 3 2

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ T 5 2

♦ K Q 4

♣ K J 6



♠ 8 5
 ♥ K 9 4 3
 ♦ J 9 3 2
 ♣ A 9 7

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

SOUTH has an opening hand, 15 points and five ♠s. But EAST beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

NORTH has 11 points, and if SOUTH had opened she would make a Limit Raise to 3 ♠.

But when replying to an Overcall, the strength needs to be a little higher. In Deal 1 it was OK to pass a 1 ♠ Overcall with 6 points, here it is correct to just raise to 2 ♠ with 11 points.

SOUTH actually has a strong Overcall so he bids 4 ♠.

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ A Q J 4
♦ Q T 4 3
♣ T 9 7

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 5 4



♠ T 8
♥ K 9 6 3
♦ J 8 5 2
♣ A Q 3

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ T 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K 8 6 2

West

1 ♥

All Pass

3 ♠ by North

North

1 ♠

East

Pass

South

3 ♠

This time NORTH has just 10 points, nowhere near an opening hand. Still, when WEST opens 1 ♥ NORTH should Overcall 1 ♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

SOUTH has 13 points. If NORTH had actually OPENED 1 ♠, SOUTH would insist on game. But NORTH didn't Open, she just Overcalled. So SOUTH must be more cautious. He jumps to 3 ♠ and NORTH shows her minimum type hand by passing.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 7
♥ K 9 8 2
♦ J 6 5 2
♣ J 4

♠ K 9 8 6

♥ 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ K Q 7 5



♠ 4 2

♥ A Q J 6 3

♦ T 9 4

♣ T 9 3

♠ A T 5 3

♥ T 7 5

♦ Q 8

♣ A 8 6 2

NORTH has 15 points, a singleton in the opponent's suit and 4-card support for any suit partner might name. In other words, a perfect Takeout Double.

SOUTH needs to make a medium-strong bid to apprise NORTH of her 10 points. She jumps to 2♠.

NORTH's hand is now worth 17 points because of the singleton. Since he is quite happy with ♠s he bids 4♠.

West

1♥

Pass

All Pass

4♠ by South

North

Dbl

4♠

East

Pass

South

2♠